

Printing a deck

the print theme and the pacing clock

chalkdeck

2026

Why a separate theme

- The board themes flood the page with a dark field: fine on a projector, ruinous on a printer.
- print has no backdrop, black on white, and colours dark enough to survive a monochrome laser.
- Nothing else changes — the same `slide` and `slide-block`.

The clock in the corner

What it is

The time you should be **at** on reaching this slide. Glance at the corner, glance at your watch: ahead or behind.

Or a real one

Typst cannot write a form field, but the PDF can carry one. Pass `clock: (live: true)` and run `tools/pdfclock.py` for powerdot's actual ticking clock.

Spelling it

```
#show: chalkdeck.with(clock: 20)           //  
minutes  
#show: chalkdeck.with(clock: duration(minutes: 45)) // or  
a duration  
#show: chalkdeck.with(clock: (total: 45, mode: "remaining"))  
#show: chalkdeck.with(clock: (n, total) => [#n of #total])  
#slide(clock: none)[ .. ]                // and off for one slide
```

mode: is "elapsed" (default), "remaining" or "both".

A really ticking clock

- `clock: (live: true)` leaves an invisible marker in the corner.
- `python3 tools/pdfclock.py deck.pdf` covers each marker with a read-only PDF form field and attaches `app.setInterval` — the same mechanism `powerdot` uses.
- It ticks in Acrobat and is inert elsewhere, exactly like `powerdot`'s.

```
python3 tools/pdfclock.py deck.pdf -o deck-live.pdf
```

```
python3 tools/pdfclock.py deck.pdf --countdown 45    # time  
REMAINING
```

Turned off here

This slide passed clock: none, so the corner is empty: a title slide or a full-bleed figure should not have to carry the furniture.

Counting down

And this one overrides the mode, so the corner shows what is **left** rather than what has gone.